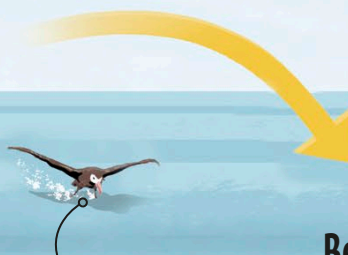


Albatross

Some animals breed slowly but live long enough to produce babies over many years. Wandering albatrosses manage this in a lifelong partnership. Males and females come together to produce just one egg every two years—but can remain as a couple for half a century.



Albatrosses usually pluck food from just below the surface but sometimes plunge deeper.

Becoming a parent

It takes a long time for an albatross to grow up and become a parent. Couples won't pair up until both partners are at least 10 years old.



Mating for life

Albatrosses are alone for most of the year. But in November, they come together on remote grassy islands in the cold Southern Ocean, where they greet each other and mate.

Black-backed jackal A faithful breeding partnership works for black-backed jackals, just as it does for albatrosses—even their pups stick around to help their parents raise the next brood.



Prairie vole Most male voles mate with several females, but male prairie voles have a single partner and play an equal role in raising their babies.



Crested gibbon Daily grooming between the male (left) and female (right) helps strengthen the bond between gibbons, which is important for successfully raising their babies.

